How to use this sheet

Trip Budget Tracker · guess it, log it, get smarter about it every trip.

Fill Plan A before the trip

Not exact — rough. The "bump" column already adds the classic overshoot for each category, so a modest Plan A guess totals something you can actually trust. If your totals sit well below the bump, expect them to catch up.

Two minutes each evening

Log the day's spend at night and it stays two minutes. A photo of each receipt during the day makes evening matching fast and errant cash moments rare. Skip a day? Guess and mark it — a good-enough log beats a perfect one that stops.

Rounding is allowed

Logging to the nearest dollar (or whole local-currency unit) keeps the whole page legible. Exact numbers cause exact quitting.

Next-trip Plan A fixes itself

After the trip, the "come home" table shows which category was off. Yank that insight into the next trip's Plan A and each trip gets cheaper to plan, calmer to run, and easier to enjoy.

Trip Budget Tracker

Estimate before you go, log while you're there, and the surprise budget math never happens.

Plan A — what I think it will cost

CATEGORY	BEST GUESS	LIKELY REAL-WORLD BUMP	MY NUMBER
Lodging		+ 10%	
Food & drinks		+ 20%	
Getting around (local transit, cabs, fuel)		+ 15%	
Getting there (flights, long trains)		+ 5%	
Fun, entry fees & souvenirs		+ 20%	
Everything unplanned		say 10% of the rest	

Plan B — what I actually spend on the road

DAY	LODGING	FOOD	TRANSPORT	FUN	OTHER	NOTES
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						

Come home & do the math

CATEGORY	COLUMN TOTAL	PLAN GUESS	OFF BY HOW MUCH?
Lodging			
Food			
Transport			
Fun			
Other			
Trip total			

The two-minute daily habit

Log the day's spend each evening or you won't log it at all. A photo of each receipt during the day makes evening matching fast. Next trip gets a smarter Plan A.